



GRADUATE DIPLOMA IN MANAGEMENT

February 2026

GDM 601: Leadership and Management in a Digital Economy

(Batch 89)

Case Study (Pre-seen)

Qualification	ATHE Level 6 Graduate Diploma in Management
Issued Date	7 February 2026
Module Tutor	Nisansala Perera
Exam Date & Time	22 February 2026 - 9.00 am – 12.10 pm

Learning Outcomes:

By the end of this unit, learners will be able to:

- LO1:** Understand the approaches to leadership and management to meet organisational objectives
- LO2:** Apply theories of management and leadership to support teams in achieving goals

RYAN MCINERNEY: LEADERSHIP BEHIND A GLOBAL PAYMENTS GIANT

Ryan McInerney has been the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Visa Inc. since 2023, one of the world's largest global digital payments companies. He is responsible for setting the organisation's overall direction, defining long-term priorities, and guiding decision-making at the highest level. His role involves shaping strategies that affect millions of consumers, businesses, and financial institutions worldwide. Under his leadership, Visa continues to expand its global payment network, ensuring secure and reliable transactions across more than 200 countries. Under McInerney's strong Finance expertise, Visa has strengthened partnerships with global banks, fintech firms, and digital wallet providers such as Apple Pay and Google Pay, enabling smooth and secure cross-border transactions.

McInerney is known for encouraging innovation and adaptability across the organisation. He has guided Visa in responding effectively to rapid changes in technology and customer behaviour, particularly in the area of digital payments. He has mainly contributed to the expansion of contactless payment solutions such as "Tap to Pay" and "Tap to Phone," which allow smartphones to operate as payment terminals for small businesses. McInerney drives change, and aligns employees with Visa's long-term vision. Rather than focusing only on short-term operational efficiency, McInerney articulated a vision of a more inclusive, secure, and digitally connected global payments ecosystem.

People play a central role in Ryan McInerney's approach to leadership. He emphasises collaboration, mutual respect, and shared responsibility as key drivers of success. At Visa, this approach is reflected through employee development initiatives, inclusive workplace practices, and opportunities for continuous learning. Support for flexible working arrangements and digital training platforms helps employees adapt to changing work environments. Furthermore, cooperation across regions and functions enables teams from technology, security, and customer experience areas to work together in delivering improved payment solutions. This environment strengthens trust, commitment, and overall organisational effectiveness.

Under McInerney's guidance, the organisation has expanded its services while maintaining high standards of security and operational reliability. His steady leadership during periods of rapid growth in digital payments has enabled Visa to remain competitive and dependable within the global payments industry.

LEARNING OUTCOMES AND ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

Learning Outcomes	Pass	Merit	Distinction
1. Understand the approaches to leadership and management to meet organisational objectives	1.1 Discuss different approaches to leadership and management to meet organisational objectives	1M1 Analyse different leadership and management performance and competences to meet organisation objectives	1D1 Recommend suitable leadership and management approaches in different organisational context to meet organisation objectives and achieve goals
2. Apply theories of management and leadership to support teams in achieving goals	2.1 Apply a range of management and leadership theories to creating teams for given organisation contexts	2M1 Compare the impact of different theories of management and leadership, and their impact in given organisation contexts	

~ End of Paper ~

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